

# THE MODERN FACE OF feminism

## 673

**Women's Marches**  
were held in the  
US in 2017, with  
**4 million people**  
in attendance

THE THIRD WAVE AND BEYOND

In the 1990s, feminists seeking to address the perceived limitations of the second wave (see pp. 272–275) began to refer to their work as the third wave. Activists and theorists of this new wave wanted to make feminism more inclusive and focused less on questions of societal oppression and more on individual agency and empowerment. In reality, however, the third wave and its predecessor were not so distinct, and had plenty of overlap, as many of the same people and issues continued to be a part of feminist discussions.

During the 1990s, popular culture became a means of transformation and activism, with the rise of a feminist punk music scene, zine (self-published, small-circulation magazine) culture, and major feminist interventions in the art world. One example of this new brand of activism was the Riot Grrrl movement, which began on the West Coast of the US in 1991 in response to the male-dominated punk music scene. One of the first bands associated with Riot Grrrl was Bikini Kill, headed by Kathleen Hanna. Riot Grrrl groups started up across the world, with many group-publishing their own zines and manifestos to spread the message of a girl-power revolution.

### Intersectional feminism

During the second wave, black feminists had begun to critique the white-centric focus of the feminist movement. In 1989, feminist legal scholar Kimberlé Crenshaw coined the term “intersectionality,” which became central to

### ◀ Punk rock feminism

The 1990s band Bikini Kill and its frontwoman Kathleen Hanna led the Riot Grrrl punk movement with lyrics that addressed issues of sexual abuse, racism, patriarchy, and female empowerment.

